UNIVERSITEIT VAN AMSTERDAM
Faculteit der Maatschappij- en
Gedragswetenschappen

Computational
Social Science

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To whom it may concern,

I am a Lecturer and the Course and Teaching Assistant (TA) Coordinator in the Computational Social Science Bachelor's programme at the University of Amsterdam. It is my great pleasure to provide this letter of recommendation for Néstor Narbona Chulvi, who worked with me as a Teaching Assistant for a year in 2023.

Néstor was an important member of our TA team supporting first-year students. He was assigned to assist in the Digital Expertise trajectory, a core component of our programme aimed at developing students' computational thinking, programming, web development, database management, and data analysis skills using Python. The programme serves an international cohort of students with highly diverse academic backgrounds, ranging from complete beginners to students with substantial prior programming experience. Teaching in this context requires not only strong technical knowledge but also care and pedagogical flexibility to varying levels of prior knowledge. Néstor consistently demonstrated these qualities throughout his work with me.

One of Néstor's primary responsibilities was leading weekly tutorial sessions for a group of approximately 20 students. During these sessions, he effectively combined the teaching materials I provided with his own explanations and instructional strategies tailored to the specific needs of his students. Based on both my own observations and student feedback, he created an engaging and supportive learning environment in which students felt comfortable asking questions and developing their programming skills.

Beyond his regular teaching duties, Néstor also made valuable contributions to the development of our course materials. On his own initiative, he identified and curated several publicly available datasets and designed excellent practice exercises to help students learn and apply data cleaning and exploratory data analysis techniques using Python. This initiative demonstrated not only his technical competence but also his creativity and genuine commitment to improving the learning experience for our students.

Overall, Néstor has proven to be a highly reliable and genuine individual who approaches his work with a strong sense of ownership and care. It has been a great pleasure working with him as he is not only a highly reliable colleague but also very social and proactive, contributing positively to the team environment. I am confident that Néstor's analytical abilities, strong work ethic, and intellectual curiosity will translate into excellent performance in his future positions in this career path.

Please feel free to contact me should you require any further information.

Sincerely,
Gizem Aktas
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